

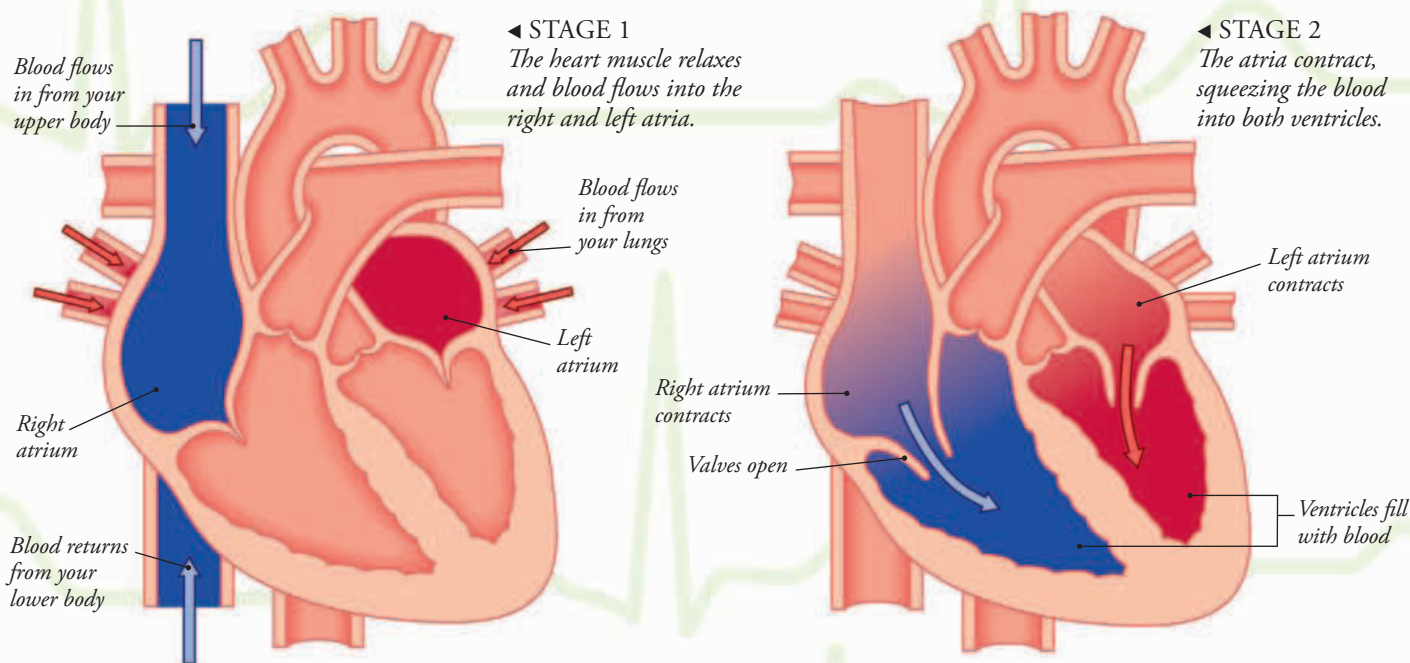
Working pump

Every minute of your life, your powerful heart keeps pumping blood around your body to supply it with oxygen and nutrients. This amazing natural pump works in phases, first sucking in blood through one set of tubes, then forcing it out through a different set. The heart relaxes and then repeats the action—over and over again, day after day.

YOUR BEATING HEART

Your heart is like two pumps in one. The right side pumps oxygen-poor blood into your lungs, where it picks up fresh supplies of oxygen, while the left side pumps oxygen-rich blood to every part of your body. This heartbeat is made up of three stages, and it only takes about a second to complete the whole cycle.

- Oxygen-rich blood
- Oxygen-poor blood



HEART RATE

Your heartbeat cycle is controlled by a special heart muscle in the right atrium that acts as a natural pacemaker. The muscle sends out electrical signals to your atria and ventricles to make them contract. The signals can be detected by an electrical heart monitor, called an ECG. By looking at the signals, a doctor can check whether your heart has a normal rhythm.

ECG RECORDING

A graphlike recording is made by an ECG. This reading shows a regular heart rhythm.

This peak shows the ventricles contracting to pump blood out of the heart.

This flat line shows when the heart muscle is relaxed.